

SARATH SURENDRAN

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SUMMARY

Cloud security, identity and vulnerability management engineer working across Azure, Microsoft Entra ID and Defender for Cloud, currently assessing and remediating security posture across enterprise Azure, AWS, Microsoft 365 and Hybrid tenants. Bringing eight years of engineering experience across enterprise environments, Entra ID and Active Directory at scale, Conditional Access and identity lifecycle, CIS hardening, and vulnerability management across large hybrid estates, followed by an MSc in Cybersecurity Risk Management at University of Galway. Looking for hands-on cloud security, identity or vulnerability management roles.

CORE SKILLS

Cloud & Platform Security: Microsoft Defender for Cloud (CSPM), Azure, AWS, Microsoft 365, CIS Benchmarks, secure configuration baselines, Azure Policy, container security (Docker, Kubernetes)

Identity & Access Management: Microsoft Entra ID, Active Directory, Conditional Access, MFA, RBAC and least privilege, privileged access, Group Policy, LDAP, Microsoft Intune

Vulnerability & Exposure Management: Qualys, Rapid7, Nessus, vulnerability lifecycle management, risk-based prioritisation (CVSS, exploitability, business impact), patch governance, SCCM, attack surface management, remediation SLAs, risk registers

Governance, Risk & Compliance: ISO 27001, NIST CSF, GDPR, NIS2, PCI DSS, SOC 2, risk register and control assessment, residual risk analysis, executive risk reporting

AI & Automation: Microsoft Copilot, Claude, applied GenAI for security triage, reporting and detection tuning, AI usage policy advisory

Security Monitoring & Reporting: Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), Splunk (SPL), Microsoft Purview, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, ServiceNow

Infrastructure & Automation: Windows Server, Linux, VMware ESXi, Hyper-V, PowerShell, Python, Bash

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Arctic Wolf Networks

Cyber Security Consultant

Ireland

Mar 2026 - Present

- Conduct security posture assessments across enterprise Azure, AWS and Microsoft 365 environments, identifying gaps in access controls, MFA enforcement and over-provisioned privileged accounts, and delivering prioritized remediation plans with assigned ownership.
- Serve as the designated security engineer for a portfolio of enterprise customers, performing recurring cloud, endpoint and identity posture reviews and converting findings into documented remediation plans with clear owners and timelines.
- Review customer pentest reports, draft incident response plans, triage tickets and tune detection queries using Copilot and Claude, while advising customers on AI usage policies to prevent data disclosure and misuse.
- Map every recommendation to NIST CSF and CIS benchmarks, giving customers audit-ready justification for each control.
- Lead recurring security review calls with technical and non-technical stakeholders, presenting technical findings in business terms to secure stakeholder commitment on specific remediation actions.

SimplifiedCS - [simplifiedcs.net](#)

Independent Project, following full-time MSc

Dublin, Ireland

Nov 2024 - Feb 2026

- Designed and built an AI-enhanced cybersecurity assessment platform with an adaptive assessment engine, findings traced to specific NIST CSF and CIS Controls requirements, and retrieval-augmented enrichment against live CISA/NVD threat intelligence to generate tailored risk-remediation recommendations.
- Engineered a compounding-risk detection layer with the assistance from Gen AI tools (Claude Code and Codex) that cross-references answers to surface dangerous combinations a per-question checklist would miss, each flagged finding mapped to the specific MITRE ATT&CK technique it enables, paired with a compensating control tailored to the reported environment.
- Completed hands-on training labs in DevSecOps, Cloud Security and Offensive Security through TryHackMe and completed CompTIA Security+ certification while doing part time jobs.

Wipro Limited

Senior Security Engineer

Bengaluru, India

Oct 2021 - Aug 2023

- Deployed the Microsoft security stack across five enterprise tenants, covering Entra ID, Intune, Defender for Cloud and Purview. Configured Conditional Access, MFA enforcement, device compliance and identity lifecycle controls that closed the access-control gaps raised in customer audits.
- Assessed and remediated Azure misconfigurations using Microsoft Defender for Cloud, enforcing security baselines across multi-tenant environments and improving Microsoft Secure Score across all managed tenants.
- Hardened Windows Server build standards against CIS baselines, cutting post-deployment vulnerabilities by 52% and removing a recurring source of audit findings.
- Wrote KQL and SPL queries in Microsoft Sentinel and Splunk to evidence control coverage and surface identity misconfiguration, feeding those gaps back into Conditional Access and privileged access baselines.
- Led a team of 15 engineers and analysts covering five customers and twelve subsidiaries, defining the secure configuration standards adopted across the team.
- Reviewed and approved changes for security impact within ITIL change, problem and incident processes in ServiceNow, providing input to control reviews.

Commvault Systems

Threat and Vulnerability Management Engineer

Bengaluru, India

Sep 2020 - Sep 2021

- Ran the vulnerability management lifecycle across more than 600 hybrid systems spanning Windows, Linux, Docker and multi-cloud. Prioritised by CVSS, exploitability and business impact using Qualys and Rapid7, reducing critical vulnerabilities by 32% within SLA.
- Maintained the vulnerability risk register and produced monthly executive reports on control gaps, remediation status and residual risk, informing senior leadership on outstanding remediation priorities.
- Validated remediation with infrastructure teams to confirm fixes held, supplying remediation evidence for ISO 27001, PCI DSS and SOC 2 audit cycles.

Hewlett Packard Enterprise

Infrastructure Security Engineer

Bengaluru, India

Jul 2019 - Sep 2020

- Carried out security assessments and hardening reviews across more than 100 virtualised infrastructure nodes, identifying the misconfigurations and control gaps behind repeat findings and reducing recurring security incidents by 20%.
- Implemented RBAC, secure configuration baselines and patch governance across VMware and Hyper-V environments, remediating access control weaknesses identified during assessment.

Tata Consultancy Services

IT Analyst, Identity and Access Administration

Bengaluru, India

Aug 2015 - Jun 2019

- Administered Active Directory and identity access for 10,000+ users and 300+ servers, enforcing least-privilege RBAC, managing the joiner-mover-leaver lifecycle and tightening group policy.
- Automated identity administration and access reporting in PowerShell, reducing manual provisioning and access review effort by 25%.
- Ran enterprise patching and vulnerability remediation through SCCM and Rapid7, reducing the estate's exposed attack surface.
- Earned promotion to subject matter expert within six months, defining the identity administration standards adopted by a 15-person team.

EDUCATION

University of Galway

MSc, Cybersecurity Risk Management

Galway, Ireland

Sep 2023 - Sep 2024

- Coursework: cybersecurity risk management, cloud security, GDPR and IT law, NIST framework, project management.
- Research Project: Integrating Cyber Honeypots & Sandboxing - A Conceptual Framework for Phishing Attack Mitigation.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Cloud and AI Security Engineer Associate (SC-500)
- CompTIA Security+ (2025)
- Microsoft Identity and Access Administrator (SC-300) – Expected Sept 2026
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate

LABS & TRAINING

- Completed hands-on training in DevSecOps, Cloud Security and Offensive Security through TryHackMe and Coursera.